DMC course: Week 2

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Homework



- Watch "1984" movie directed by Michael Radford.
- Read (or reread) the Preface Section on *1984*, Disciplinary Surveillance, and Narrative Analysis.
- Read the Afterword to the 1961 Signet edition of *1984*, by Eric Fromm.
  - Here is a copy on the course website.
  - If this is too verbose, you may read instead, the Claude AI Summary of Fromm's Afterword.
- Extra Credit: Send me a link to an article about recent world events that mentions (or very well could mention) George Orwell, the book *1984*, or related terms. If you like, give a brief description of the article and/or how Orwellian concepts come up. I will compile all of the responses and send them out on Sunday, Nov. 8, the day before the next class. I will also put the compilation on our website. I will credit contributors by first name only, unless they mention they prefer to be anonymous.
- Double Extra Credit: Browse the link to our website References and Info for Week 2: 1984. The link to this (at the end of the last sentence) can be found on the page of our website obtained by clicking on the dropdown References and Info.

For convenience, I have attached PDF versions of the course preface, Erich Fromm's afterword, and ClaudeAI's Summary of Fromm's Afterword.

Question to Guide Reflection

Questions in Preface Section on *1984*, Disciplinary Surveillance, and Narrative Analysis

- *Mental control often attempts to flatten a person's inner life. How does the narrative use the "intentional states" (private thoughts) of the characters to defy the external world?*
- *In a "mentally controlled world," the system provides the "canonical script" (how one should think and act). How does the protagonist of our story create a "breach" in that script?*
- *In propaganda-heavy worlds, "truth" is whatever the state says. How does a "tale of defiance" use "narrative truth" to expose the lies of "systemic truth"?*
- *Why do we often use the "Dystopian" genre to talk about mental control? How does the genre itself help us understand what "defiance" looks like?*
- *What helps or hurts the ability of individual acts of defiance "accrue" into a movement?*

Questions following up on Fromm's Afterword

- *Can the longing for freedom be extinguished, or does human nature push back, as a defiance to mind control?*
  In other words, that is in the words of O'Brien turned into a question:

  > *Can a boot stamp on a human face forever?*

- *Does the severity of the methods used by the state prove the strength of what they suppress?*
  Do severe methods actually increase the stength of the defiant?
- Is history really written by the victors?
  Is truth written by those in power?

Week2 Class Presentation

- links will be provide after class is held